

Marital Status by Ethnic Group

Table 9.2 shows the distribution of the population by ethnic group, sex, and marital status.

Table 9.2 : Marital Status by Ethnic group and Sex, 2024

Ethnic group	Male/ Female	Total	Never Married	Married	Widowed	Divorced	Separated (Legally)	Separated (Not legally)
Sri Lanka	Grand Total	21,781,800	9,100,150	11,161,078	1,234,418	74,355	44,904	166,895
		100.0	41.8	51.2	5.7	0.3	0.2	0.8
	Male	10,512,344	4,808,324	5,417,431	175,421	28,952	17,047	65,169
		100.0	45.7	51.5	1.7	0.3	0.2	0.6
	Female	11,269,456	4,291,826	5,743,647	1,058,997	45,403	27,857	101,726
		100.0	38.1	51.0	9.4	0.4	0.2	0.9
Sinhalese	Male	7,797,618	3,466,465	4,108,376	132,157	22,659	14,190	53,771
		100.0	44.5	52.7	1.7	0.3	0.2	0.7
	Female	8,346,419	3,103,304	4,315,965	805,320	29,347	20,190	72,293
		100.0	37.2	51.7	9.6	0.4	0.2	0.9
Sri Lanka Tamil	Male	1,286,998	614,117	639,373	22,547	2,051	1,337	7,573
		100.0	47.7	49.7	1.8	0.2	0.1	0.6
	Female	1,394,629	546,500	686,231	133,774	4,171	3,419	20,534
		100.0	39.2	49.2	9.6	0.3	0.2	1.5
Indian Tamil/ Malaiyaga Thamilar	Male	288,368	135,932	143,516	6,829	371	247	1,473
		100.0	47.1	49.8	2.4	0.1	0.1	0.5
	Female	311,992	126,358	149,035	32,895	666	427	2,611
		100.0	40.5	47.8	10.5	0.2	0.1	0.8
Sri Lanka Moor/ Muslim	Male	1,103,726	576,553	506,974	13,189	3,654	1,189	2,167
		100.0	52.2	45.9	1.2	0.3	0.1	0.2
	Female	1,179,520	502,703	572,992	83,305	10,880	3,664	5,976
		100.0	42.6	48.6	7.1	0.9	0.3	0.5
Burgher	Male	15,243	6,511	8,181	326	99	36	90
		100.0	42.7	53.7	2.1	0.6	0.2	0.6
	Female	16,478	5,792	8,535	1,758	136	87	170
		100.0	35.1	51.8	10.7	0.8	0.5	1.0
Malay	Male	12,696	5,563	6,715	271	76	32	39
		100.0	43.8	52.9	2.1	0.6	0.3	0.3
	Female	13,954	4,929	7,322	1,401	155	52	95
		100.0	35.3	52.5	10.0	1.1	0.4	0.7
Other	Male	7,695	3,183	4,296	102	42	16	56
		100.0	41.4	55.8	1.3	0.5	0.2	0.7
	Female	6,464	2,240	3,567	544	48	18	47
		100.0	34.7	55.2	8.4	0.7	0.3	0.7

Others – This category includes Sri Lanka Chetty, Bharata, Veddass, and other ethnic groups.

According to Table 9.2, the highest percentage of never-married males and females is observed among the Sri Lanka Moors (Muslim) community. Among the Sinhalese, Burgher, Malay and other ethnic groups, the percentage of married persons exceeds 50 percent for both males and females. Among the Sinhalese population, 52.7 percent of males and 51.7 percent of females are married, respectively. The corresponding percentages among the Burghers are 53.7 percent and 51.8 percent, respectively, while among the Malays community the percentages are 52.9 percent and 52.5 percent, respectively. The percentage of widowed females is higher among the Burgher and Indian Tamil/Malaiyaga Thamilar ethnicities, at 10.7 percent and 10.5 percent, respectively. The highest percentage of divorced females is reported among the Malay community, at 1.1 percent.